

Carion crow

The crow has a huge brain for its size. It's so smart that it makes and uses tools, and recognizes faces. It will even teach other crows to identify a mean human!



The eider swallows mussels whole, crushing their shells in its stomach.

Common eider

The eider is the Northern Hemisphere's largest duck. Mother eiders lead their chicks to the sea, where they swim in groups of more than 150 chicks!

BARENTS SEA

This type of finch's bill is crossed at the tip, which is ideal for pulling conifer seeds out of cones.



Parrot crossbill

Used as Christmas trees, the Norway spruce can grow to 131 ft (40m) in height and live for 1,000 years.

Also called the fish eagle, the osprey plunges into water feetfirst to grab fish with its talons.



Osprey

The wolverine is the biggest member of the weasel family. It has a bite so powerful it can crush bone.



Wolverine

RUSSIAN FEDERATION

The jay survives cold winters by storing food, especially berries. It hides them in trees, or covers them with bark and lichens.



Siberian jay

SCALE

0 100 miles
0 100 kilometers

HABITAT KEY

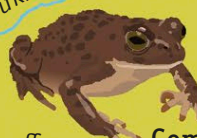
- Mountains
- Coniferous forests
- Deciduous forests

Male capercaillies perform a dance in an area called a "lek" to attract females. They put their tails up, their wings down, and make sounds like popping corks!



Western capercaillie

This toad's skin gives off a nasty substance that stops most predators from eating it. It can live for up to 40 years.



Common toad

Stoat

The stoat is a lightning-fast member of the weasel family. Usually reddish brown, its coat turns white in winter, making it hard to see against the snow. The tip of its tail, however, stays dark.



When a stoat has its white coat, it's called an ermine.

Location

This part of the taiga runs across the top of Europe eastward to the Ural Mountains in western Russia. Winters here are very cold and snowy.

